Topic 6 — Socio-Religious Reform Movements

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

Raja (राजा) Ram Mohan Roy (राम मोहन राय) | Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar (विद्यासागर) | Jyotiba Phule (ज्योतिबा फुले) | Satyashodhak Samaj (सत्यशोधक) | Behramji Malabari (मालाबारी) | D.K. Karve (कर्वे) | Muslim Reform Movements (Wahabi (वहाबी), Faraizi (फ़राज़ी), Ahmadiyya) | Major Socio-Religious Institutions | Bengal Reform Movements | Young Bengal | Social Reformers and Their Titles | Brahmo Samaj (ब्रह्म समाज) | Arya Samaj (आर्य समाज) | Prarthana Samaj (प्रार्थना समाज) | Paramahansa Mandali (परमहंस मंडली) | Ramakrishna (रामकृष्ण) Mission (रामकृष्ण मिशन) | Aligarh (अलीगढ़) Movement (अलीगढ़ आंदोलन) | Deoband (देवबंद) Movement | Theosophical Society (थियोसोफिकल सोसायटी) | Vivekananda (विवेकानंद) | Dayanand Saraswati (सरस्वती) | Sir Syed Ahmad Khan (सर सैयद) | Annie Besant (बेसेंट) | Sree Narayana Dharma Paripalana Yogam (SNDP) | Sri Narayana Guru (गुरु) | Singh Sabha (सिंह सभा) Movement | Pandita Ramabai (रमाबाई) | Self-Respect Movement (स्वाभिमान आंदोलन) | E.V. Ramaswami Naicker (Periyar (पेरियार))

Sources baked in: NCERT Themes III, Spectrum, Bipan Chandra, Ghatnachakra Purvalokan (Socio-Religious Movements), UPPCS Prelims 2018–2025 **Weight:** ★★★ — founder ↔ institution, reformer ↔ work, Malabari / Age of Consent, Phule–Satyashodhak, region-stream traps (SNDP/Singh Sabha/Self-Respect) **Last verified:** September 2026 gap audit — Brahmo/Arya/Aligarh/Singh Sabha/Theosophy/Phule/Narayana Guru map confirmed; Young Bengal card expanded; Extra Drill present (no invented mega banks) **Current Affairs:** N/A (historical)

6.0 One clear picture — five reform streams by region

Nineteenth-century reform did **not** happen as one national movement. It grew in **regional streams**, each answering local pressures (missionaries, caste rigidity, colonial law). Hold this map first; every later card plugs into it.

Stream	Core region	Lead names	Central method	Key fact
Bengal	Calcutta and the Bengal presidency	Rammohan Roy, Debendranath Tagore, Vidyasagar, Keshab Chandra Sen, Derozio	Reasoned monotheism, print and English education, law reform (Sati, widow remarriage)	Brahmo Samaj; Sati **1829**; Widow Remarriage **1856**
Maharashtra	Bombay–Poona belt	Dadoba Pandurang, Atmaram Pandurang, M.G. Ranade, Jyotiba Phule, Pandita Ramabai, D.K. Karve	Anti-caste and anti-idolatry sabhas, women's education, widow remarriage in practice	Prarthana Samaj **1867**; Satyashodhak **1873**

Stream	Core region	Lead names	Central method	Key fact
Punjab	Amritsar–Lahore belt	Dayanand Saraswati (Arya base shifted here), Khem Singh Bedi, Gurmukh Singh	Vedic revivalism (Arya) and Sikh identity revivalism (Singh Sabha), both against missionary inroads	Arya Samaj strong in Punjab; Singh Sabha **1873**
South	Madras presidency, Kerala, Tamil country	Sri Narayana Guru, E.V. Ramaswami Naicker (Periyar), Annie Besant (Adyar base)	Anti-caste temple entry (मंदिर प्रवेश) and priestcraft attack, rationalist self-respect	SNDP **1903**; Self-Respect **1925**
Muslim streams	North India and Bengal	Sayyid Ahmad of Rae Bareli, Haji Shariatullah, Mirza Ghulam Ahmad, Sir Syed Ahmad Khan, Nanautawi/Gangohi	Ranges from militant revival to modern loyalist college to traditional seminary	Aligarh **1875**; Deoband **1866** (full comparative table in §6.7)

- No stream is purely religious or purely social. Bengal and Maharashtra reform pushed **law changes** (Sati, widow remarriage, age of consent). Punjab and the South pushed **identity and caste** questions harder.
- The **South stream** (SNDP, Self-Respect) is asked less often than Bengal/Maharashtra in UPPCS, but it is standard NCERT/coaching material and worth full cards, not a one-line footnote.
- Muslim reform is its **own axis**, not a regional stream — it splits by **orientation** (loyalist college vs traditional seminary vs militant revival vs peaceful messianic), not by one geography.

> **Logic:** When a question names an unfamiliar body, first place it on this map — region + method — before recalling the exact founder and year.

6.1 Raja Ram Mohan Roy

- He is called the **Father of the Indian Renaissance** (about **1772–1833**).
- In **1815** he founded **Atmiya Sabha** in Calcutta for discussion against idolatry and social evils.
- In **1828** he founded **Brahmo Sabha**, later called **Brahmo Samaj** (ब्रह्म समाज).
- He campaigned against **Sati**. **Lord William Bentinck** banned Sati in **1829** (Regulation XVII).
- He brought out the paper **Sambad Kaumudi** and wrote **Tuhfat-ul-Muwahhidin** (a monotheist tract).
- He stood for modern education, including English, and for the use of reason in religion.
- **Mughal (मुग़ल) emperor Akbar II** gave him the title **Raja** (**1830**) and sent him to England on the pension question; he died at **Bristol in 1833** (samadhi (समाधि) there).
- He did **not** oppose Western education — he backed English and scientific learning. **Samachar Chandrika** (Bhavani Charan (चारण)) was started against his reform line.
- He did **not** found Arya Samaj or Satyashodhak Samaj.

> **Logic:** Roy + Sati **1829** + Brahmo **1828**. Satyashodhak is **Phule**, not Roy.

6.2 Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar

- He was a Sanskrit scholar and social reformer of Bengal.
- He was **Principal of the Sanskrit College, Calcutta**.
- He led the campaign for **widow remarriage**. The **Hindu Widows' Remarriage Act** was passed in **1856**.
- He also worked for women's education and against child marriage and polygamy.
- He is **not** the Secretary of the Widow Remarriage Association. That post in the 2022 match is **D.K. Karve**.

> **Logic:** Vidyasagar = Sanskrit College + Widow Remarriage Act **1856**. Bethune = girls' school.

6.3 Jyotiba Phule

- He worked in Maharashtra against **caste inequality** and for the education of girls and lower castes.
- He is associated with the **Anti-caste Movement**, not Civil Disobedience (सविनय अवज्ञा), trade (पण्याध्यक्ष) unions or a peasant party.
- With **Savitribai Phule** he opened schools for girls and for the lower castes.
- He wrote **Gulamgiri (गुलामगिरी) (1873)** against caste slavery.
- **Shetkaryacha Asud** is another of his works.
- He founded **Satyashodhak Samaj** in **1873** (next section).

> **Logic:** Phule ≠ peasant movement in the 2022 option set. The right label is **anti-caste**.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS 2022 Q1): Jyotiba Phule** was associated primarily with the **Anti-caste Movement** in Maharashtra (not peasant or trade union movements as primary categorization).

6.4 Satyashodhak Samaj

- Founded by **Jyotiba Phule in 1873**.
- The name means a society for **seeking truth**.
- It attacked Brahmanical monopoly of religion and stood for the dignity of lower castes and women.
- It is **not** the same as Prarthana Samaj (Ranade) or Brahmo Samaj (Roy).
- **Tarabai Shinde** wrote *Stri Purush Tulana*.
- She is linked to this stream but is **not** the founder.

> **Logic:** Founder = **Phule**. Common traps: Roy and Ranade as founders of the Satyashodhak Samaj.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS 2022 Q84):** The **Satyashodhak Samaj** (Society of Truth Seekers) was founded in 1873 by **Jyotiba Phule** to liberate Shudras and Ati-Shudras from Brahmanical domination.

6.5 Behramji Malabari

- He was a **Parsi reformer of Bombay**.
- He led a **crusade against child marriage**.
- He advocated the **Age of Consent Act, 1891**, which raised the age of consent for girls.
- **Bal Gangadhar Tilak** and the extremist (गरम दल) wing **opposed** the Act. They said the British should not interfere in Hindu marriage.
- Malabari supported the 1891 Act; Tilak and the Extremists did **not**.
- Later, the **Sharda Act (1929)** raised the statutory marriage ages again (girls **14**, boys **18**).

> **Logic:** Malabari supported the 1891 Act. Tilak did **not**.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q17

With reference to the Age of Consent Act, 1891 consider the following statements:

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS 2024 Q17): Age of Consent Act (1891)** was enacted due to relentless advocacy by Parsi reformer **Behramji M. Malabari**. It was **opposed** by Bal Gangadhar Tilak and orthodox Hindus as colonial encroachment.

6.6 D.K. Karve

Dhondo Keshav Karve (1858–1962) | Poona / Bombay | practised what he preached

- He worked for widow remarriage and women's education in western India.
- In the UPPCS 2022 match he is **Secretary, Widow Remarriage Association**.
- After his first wife died, he himself **remarried a widow, Godubai, in 1893** — a rare act of practice, not just preaching.
- In **1896** he founded the **Hindu Widows' Home Association** at **Hingne**, near Poona, to shelter and educate widows.
- In **1916** he founded the **Indian Women's University** at Poona, the **first women's university in India**.
- The university was renamed the **S.N.D.T. Women's University** in **1920** after a donation from Sir Vithaldas Thackersey in memory of his mother, Shreemati Nathibai Damodar (दामोदर) Thackersey.

- He was awarded the **Bharat Ratna in 1958**, one of the earliest recipients.
- Do not mix him with Vidyasagar (Sanskrit College, Calcutta) or with Malabari (child marriage / Age of Consent).

> **Logic:** Karve = Widow Remarriage Association **and** SNDT Women's University (1916/1920). Vidyasagar = Principal of Sanskrit College.

6.7 Muslim Reform Movements — one comparative card

Five distinct streams. UPPCS mixes founders and orientations as traps — learn the **row**, not just the name.

Stream	Founder / leading name	Year / place	Orientation
Wahabi / Tariqah-i-Muhammadiya	**Sayyid Ahmad of Rae Bareli** (inspired in India by **Shah Waliullah's** reform line; Arabia's Abdul Wahab is the name-tag)	From the 1820s; briefly held **Peshawar (~1830)**; died **Balakot 1831**; later Indian centre **Patna** (पटना)	Militant scriptural revival; later turned anti-Sikh and anti-British
Faraizi (फ़राज़ी)	**Haji Shariatullah**, later **Dudu Miyan**	From the 1820s, **Bengal**	Peasant Islamic puritanism; anti-landlord, anti-zamindar edge
Ahl-i-Hadith	No single founder (loose scholarly stream)	19th century, north India	Scripturalist; rejected later juristic and Sufi (सूफी) accretions
Ahmadiyya	**Mirza Ghulam Ahmad**	**1889, Qadian (Punjab)**	Peaceful, messianic and missionary; treated as heretical by orthodox Muslims
Aligarh (Aligarh Movement)	**Sir Syed Ahmad Khan**	**1875, Aligarh**	Modern Western-style college education; political loyalism to the British
Deoband (Dar-ul-Ulum)	**Muhammad Qasim Nanautawi**, **Rashid Ahmad Gangohi**	**1866, Deoband (UP)**	Traditional seminary revival of Hadith and fiqh; later turned more anti-colonial

- **Wahabi** and **Faraizi** were the earliest streams, rooted in the pre-1857 agrarian and religious unrest of Bengal and the north.
- After Balakot, Wahabi organisation ran through **Patna** with branches toward Hyderabad (हैदराबाद), Madras, Bengal, UP and Bombay.

- **Faraizi** under **Dudu Miyan** pushed an anti-English, anti-zamindar edge in eastern Bengal; later many followers merged toward the Wahabi stream (**~1818–1862** arc).
- **Ahmadiyya** is the odd one out: it is peaceful and missionary, not revivalist-militant, and mainstream Muslim orthodoxy does **not** accept it as within the fold.
- **Aligarh** and **Deoband** are the two big post-1857 north-Indian answers, and they are opposites in method though both reacted to the same crisis of Muslim decline after 1857.
- Ahmadiyya is **not** the Aligarh college line, and Wahabi is **not** the Deoband seminary line — each has its own founder and orientation.

> **Logic:** Sir Syed ≠ Deoband. Nanautawi ≠ MAO College. Ahmadiyya ≠ Wahabi (peaceful vs militant).

6.8 Major Socio-Religious Institutions

This is the **match home** for founder, year, place, and the 2022 organisation–city trap.

Institution	Founder / leading name	Year / place
Atmiya Sabha	Raja Ram Mohan Roy	1815, Calcutta
Brahmo Sabha / Samaj	Raja Ram Mohan Roy	1828, Calcutta
Tattvabodhini Sabha	Debendranath Tagore	1839
Paramahansa Mandali	Dadoba Pandurang	**1849, Bombay** (secret)
Prarthana Samaj	Atmaram Pandurang (Ranade associated)	**1867, Bombay**
Arya Samaj	Dayanand Saraswati	**1875, Bombay** (later strong in Punjab / Lahore)
Satyashodhak Samaj	Jyotiba Phule	**1873**
Theosophical Society	H.P. Blavatsky and H.S. Olcott	**1875, New York**; Indian HQ **Adyar, 1882**
MAO College (Aligarh)	Sir Syed Ahmad Khan	**1875**
Dar-ul-Ulum Deoband	Muhammad Qasim Nanautawi, Rashid Ahmad Gangohi	**1866**
Ramakrishna Mission	Swami Vivekananda	**1897**
Ramakrishna Math	Vivekananda	Belur
Arya Mahila Samaj	Pandita Ramabai	**1882, Poona**
Sharada Sadan	Pandita Ramabai	**1889, Bombay/Poona**
Mukti Mission	Pandita Ramabai	**1898, Kedgaon**

Institution	Founder / leading name	Year / place
Singh Sabha (first)	Khem Singh Bedi, Thakur Singh Sandhawalia	**1873, Amritsar**
Singh Sabha (Tat Khalsa)	Gurmukh Singh, Bhai Ditt Singh	**1879, Lahore**
Chief Khalsa Diwan	United Singh Sabhas	**1902, Amritsar**
SNDP Yogam	Dr Palpu, Kumaran Asan; guided by Sri Narayana Guru	**1903, Kerala**
Self-Respect Movement	E.V. Ramaswami Naicker (Periyar)	**1925, Tamil country**
Indian Women's University (later SNDT)	D.K. Karve	**1916, Poona**
Central Hindu College	Annie Besant (with Bhagwan Das)	**1898, Banaras**

Orthodox / defensive bodies (2022 Q18 traps)

Body	Correct place
Sanatan Dharma Rakshini Sabha	**Calcutta** — this is the correctly matched pair
Radhasoami Satsang	**Agra** (आगरा), not Lahore
Bharat Dharma Mahamandal	**Varanasi (वाराणसी) / Banaras**, not Delhi
Deva Samaj (Shiv Narayan Agnihotri)	**Lahore**, not Banaras

> **Logic:** Learn the **wrong city** as well as the right one. Radhasoami is Agra. Deva Samaj is Lahore.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS 2022 Q18):** Institution Headquarters Match: **Sanatan Dharma Rakshini Sabha** ↔ Calcutta; **Radhaswami Satsang** ↔ Agra; **Bharat Dharma Mahamandal** ↔ Varanasi; **Dev Samaj** ↔ Lahore.

Other match-list bodies (civil / social)

Body	Founder / tag	Year / place
Dev Samaj	**Shiv Narayan Agnihotri**	**1887, Lahore**; book *Devshastra*
Dharma Sabha	**Radhakant Deb**	**1830, Bengal** — orthodox defence vs Brahmo reforms
Radhasoami Satsang	**Shivdayal Sahab / Tulsiram**	**1861, Agra**
Widow Remarriage Association (Maharashtra)	**Vishnu Parashuram Pandit**	**1850** campaign line

Body	Founder / tag	Year / place
Indian National Social Conference	**M.G. Ranade** and **Raghunath Rao**	**1887** — social agenda beside Congress
Servants of India Society	**Gopal Krishna (कृष्णा) Gokhale**	**1905, Poona**
Bahujan Samaj	**Mukund Rao Patil** / Shankar Rao Jadhav	**1910** — Phule-inspired lower-caste organisation
Poona Sarvajanik Sabha	Joshi / Chiplunkar stream; **Ranade** joined early	**1870** political association

- **Sharda Act (Child Marriage Restraint Act, 1929)** fixed marriage ages at **14 (girls)** and **18 (boys)**; named after **Har Bilas Sharda**.
- **Slavery** was made illegal by **Act V of 1843** under **Ellenborough**.
- **Nadars** temple-entry demand sparked **Tirunelveli riots (1899)**. Tilak's famous line: if God tolerates untouchability, he would not recognise such a God.

6.9 Bengal Reform Movements

- Bengal was the first big centre of the nineteenth-century reform debate (Calcutta elites, print, and English education).
- **Tattvabodhini Sabha (1839)** under **Debendranath Tagore** carried Brahmo ideas forward after Roy.
- The **Sati ban of 1829** belongs to this Bengal debate.
- The **Widow Remarriage Act of 1856** followed Vidyasagar's campaign.
- The **Native Marriage Act of 1872** allowed civil / Brahmo marriage without idolatrous rites.
- **Bethune** opened a girls' school in Calcutta.
- Orthodoxy also organised in Calcutta — **Sanatan Dharma Rakshini Sabha**.

Young Bengal (Derozio)

- **Henry Louis Vivian Derozio** taught at **Hindu College, Calcutta**, in the late **1820s**.
- His radical student circle is remembered as **Young Bengal**.
- They attacked idolatry, caste rigidity and blind custom, and praised reason, liberty and Western learning.
- The group was short-lived after Derozio's dismissal and early death (**1831**), but it remains the Bengal radical-student tag in match lists.
- Young Bengal is **not** Brahmo Samaj and **not** Phule's Satyashodhak work in Maharashtra.

> **Logic:** Native Marriage Act = **1872**, not 1870/74/76. Young Bengal = **Derozio / Hindu College**, not Roy or Phule.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS 2019 Q17):** The **Native Marriage Act** (Brahmo Marriage Act / Civil Marriage Act) was passed in **1872** through Keshab Chandra Sen's efforts, fixing minimum marriage age at 14 for girls and 18 for boys.

6.10 Social Reformers and Their Titles

Work-match home: Vidyasagar = Sanskrit College principal; Karve = widow remarriage crusade; Malabari = child-marriage crusade.

Person	Work / post
D.K. Karve	Secretary, Widow Remarriage Association
J.E.D. Bethune	Established a girls' school in Calcutta
Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar	Principal of Sanskrit College, Calcutta
B.M. Malabari	Crusade against child marriage

Code for List-I A–D against List-II 2, 1, 4, 3 = **option B**.

Titles and one-line tags

Person	Title / tag
Raja Ram Mohan Roy	Father of the Indian Renaissance
Dayanand Saraswati	**Martin Luther of India**; Back to the Vedas; Swaraj / Hindi / Swadeshi tags
Jyotiba Phule	Mahatma (honorific); anti-caste
Vivekananda	Chicago 1893; "sisters and brothers of America"
Annie Besant	Theosophy; later Home Rule (होम रूल) (that politics is a later topic)
M.G. Ranade	Prarthana Samaj; "father of Indian economics" is a separate tag
Gopal Hari Deshmukh	**Lokahitwadi**
Gopal Krishna Gokhale	**Servants of India Society (1905)**
E.V. Ramaswami Naicker (Periyar)	Self-Respect Movement; left Congress in **1925** (full card at §6.26)

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q90

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below.

List-I (Person) A. D. K. Karve B. J. E. D. Bethune C. Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar D. B. M. Malabari

List-II > [!TIP] Exam Anchor (UPPCS 2022 Q90): **Key Reformer Matches:** D.K. Karve ↔ **Secretary, Widow Remarriage Association;** J.E.D. Bethune ↔ **Girls School in Calcutta (Bethune College 1849);** Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar ↔ **Principal, Sanskrit College Calcutta;** B.M. Malabari** ↔ Campaign against child marriage.

6.11 Brahmo Samaj

- Started as **Brahmo Sabha in 1828** by **Raja Ram Mohan Roy**.
- It taught **one God**.
- It opposed **idol worship**.
- It attacked Sati, caste rigidity and meaningless ritual (कर्मकाण्ड).
- After Roy, **Debendranath Tagore** led the **Adi Brahmo Samaj**.
- **Keshab Chandra Sen** formed the **Brahmo Samaj of India** (**Bhartiya Brahmo Samaj**). Debendranath's wing is **Adi Brahmo Samaj** — do not swap. Keshab also linked to **Tabernacle of New Dispensation** and **Indian Reform Association**; **Calcutta Unitarian Committee** is Roy's line, not Keshab's alone.
- Debendranath founded **Tattvabodhini Sabha (1839)** to spread Roy's ideas and later appointed Keshab as Acharya.
- A further split produced the **Sadharan Brahmo Samaj (1878)**, led by figures such as **Ananda Mohan Bose**, **Shibnath Shastri** and **Umesh Chandra Dutta**, after protest against Keshab's style of leadership and the Cooch Behar marriage controversy.
- The **Native Marriage Act 1872** is linked to Brahmo / civil marriage needs.
- Brahmo Samaj is **not** "Back to the Vedas." That slogan is **Arya Samaj**.

> **Logic:** Founder = Roy **1828**. Splits = Debendranath (Adi), Keshab (Brahmo Samaj of India), then Sadharan Brahmo **1878**. Do not credit Roy with Arya Samaj.

6.12 Arya Samaj

- Founded by **Swami Dayanand Saraswati** at **Bombay in 1875**.
- It became very strong in **Punjab**, with a major centre at **Lahore**.
- The slogan was **"Back to the Vedas."**
- It rejected later Puranic accretions, idolatry and child marriage.
- It used **shuddhi** (reconversion) and built **D.A.V.** schools.
- Dayanand's book **Satyarth Prakash** is the doctrinal text. Birth name **Mulshankar**; **Pakhand Khandini Pataka** was raised in **1867**. HQ shifted to **Lahore (1877)**. Later split: **Gurukul** (गुरुकुल) line (Shraddhanand) vs **D.A.V.** line (Hansraj / Lala Lajpat Rai (लाला लाजपत राय)).
- He is often called the **Martin Luther of India**. He is also tagged as first to popularise **Swaraj**, **Hindi as national language**, and boycott (बहिष्कार) of foreign goods.
- Arya Samaj is **not** Brahmo Samaj and **not** Theosophical Society.

> **Logic:** Year **1875** is shared with MAO College. Do not mix the two founders.

6.13 Prarthana Samaj

- Founded in **Bombay in 1867** under the inspiration of **Keshab Chandra Sen**.
- **Atmaram Pandurang** is the usual founder name. **Ranade** joined about **1869** and is tagged as the cultural-renaissance driver of western India.
- **M.G. Ranade**, **R.G. Bhandarkar** and **N.G. Chandavarkar** were leading members.
- It was a western-Indian cousin of Brahmo ideas. It stressed prayer, social reform, and caste and women's questions.
- It is **not** Satyashodhak Samaj. Ranade is a trap option for Phule's sabha.

> **Logic:** Prarthana = **Bombay 1867**. Satyashodhak = **Phule 1873**.

6.14 Paramahansa Mandali

Dadoba Pandurang | **1849, Bombay** | secret precursor of Prarthana Samaj

- It was a **secret society** founded in **1849** at Bombay, well before the public Prarthana Samaj of 1867.
- Members pledged to reject **idolatry** and **caste distinctions** among themselves.
- Some members reportedly ate food cooked by lower-caste or Muslim cooks in private, breaking a personal caste taboo as a test of belief.
- **Dadoba Pandurang** was its leading figure. His brother **Atmaram Pandurang** later founded the public **Prarthana Samaj in 1867**.
- The Mandali stayed secret and small. It never became a mass public movement like Brahmo or Arya Samaj.
- It is the standard **link card** between early Bombay monotheist reform and the later, public Prarthana Samaj.

> **Logic:** Mandali = **1849, secret**. Prarthana Samaj = **1867, public**. Do not date Prarthana Samaj as 1849.

6.15 Ramakrishna Mission

- **Ramakrishna Paramahamsa** was a saint at **Dakshineswar**. He taught that different religions are paths to the same goal.
- His disciple **Swami Vivekananda** founded the **Ramakrishna Mission in 1897**.
- The Mission combines **Vedanta** (वेदांत) with **social service** (schools, relief, hospitals).
- Headquarters of the Math is at **Belur** (बेलूर).
- Vivekananda's Chicago speech is in his own section. Do not date the Mission as 1893.
- He preached **Practical Vedanta** and wrote *Raja Yoga (योग)*, *Karma (कर्म) Yoga*, *Jnana Yoga*.

- **Subhas Chandra Bose** (सुभाष चंद्र बोस) called him the spiritual father of the modern nationalist movement in Bengal.
- **Sharadamani (Sharada Devi)** was Ramakrishna's wife. **Sister Nivedita** (Margaret Noble) was Vivekananda's Western disciple.

> **Logic:** Mission = **1897**. Chicago Parliament = **1893**.

6.16 Aligarh Movement

- Led by **Sir Syed Ahmad Khan** after 1857.
- Aim: Muslims should take **modern Western education** and remain loyal enough to recover ground under British rule.
- He founded the **Muhammadan Anglo-Oriental College at Aligarh in 1875**. It later became **Aligarh Muslim University**.
- He brought out the journal **Tahzib-ul-Akhlaq**.
- He also wrote a commentary on the Quran in a modernist frame.
- After 1857 he analysed the uprising in *Asbab-e-Baghawat-e-Hind* (**1859**) and argued that Muslims needed modern education to recover under British rule.
- This is **not** Deoband. Deoband is a seminary, not MAO College.

> **Logic:** Aligarh / MAO = **Sir Syed, 1875**. Archbold as a later Principal is an Education-topic fact.

6.17 Deoband Movement

- **Dar-ul-Ulum Deoband** was founded in **1866** by **Muhammad Qasim Nanautawi** and **Rashid Ahmad Gangohi**.
- It revived **traditional Islamic learning** (Hadith, fiqh) after 1857.
- It did **not** copy Aligarh's English-college model.
- Later many Deoband-linked ulama took a more **anti-colonial** political line than Sir Syed's early loyalism.

> **Logic:** Deoband **1866** is earlier than MAO College **1875**.

6.18 Theosophical Society

- Founded in **1875 in New York** by **Helena Blavatsky** and **Henry Olcott**.
- Indian headquarters were set up at **Adyar (Madras) in 1882**.
- It taught a universal spiritual brotherhood and drew on Hindu and Buddhist ideas.

- **Annie Besant** later became its famous Indian-phase leader.
- It is **not** Arya Samaj. Dayanand and the Theosophists cooperated briefly and then fell out.

> **Logic:** Founded **1875, New York**. Indian HQ = **Adyar**, not Calcutta.

6.19 Vivekananda

- He was born **Narendranath Datta**.
- He was a disciple of **Ramakrishna**.
- He spoke at the **Parliament of Religions, Chicago, 1893**.
- He founded the **Ramakrishna Mission in 1897**.
- He stressed Vedanta, service of man as service of God, and national self-respect.
- He is **not** the founder of Arya Samaj or Brahmo Samaj.

> **Logic:** Chicago **1893**; Mission **1897**. Do not swap the two years.

6.20 Dayanand Saraswati

- He was born **Mool Shankar** in Gujarat.
- He became a sannyasi and a Vedic revivalist.
- He founded **Arya Samaj in 1875** at Bombay.
- His main book is **Satyarth Prakash**.
- He preached **"Back to the Vedas."**
- He opposed idolatry, child marriage and untouchability in the Arya frame.
- He favoured **Hindi**.
- He is **not** the founder of Brahmo Samaj or Prarthana Samaj.

> **Logic:** Dayanand = Arya Samaj **1875** + *Satyarth Prakash*.

6.21 Sir Syed Ahmad Khan

- Muslim reformer and educationist after 1857.
- He argued that Muslims needed **modern education** to survive under British rule.
- He founded **MAO College, Aligarh, in 1875** (Aligarh Movement section above).
- He wrote on the **causes of the Indian Revolt** and brought out **Tahzib-ul-Akhlaq**.
- In early politics he favoured cooperation with the British.
- He was suspicious of Congress as a Hindu-majority body.

- He is **not** a founder of Deoband.

> **Logic:** Sir Syed = Aligarh / MAO. Deoband = Nanautawi and Gangohi.

6.22 Annie Besant

Irish-born (1847–1933) | reached India **1893** | Theosophy **and** social/education reform

- She joined the **Theosophical Society** in England and moved to India in **1893** to work with the Society.
- After **Olcott's death**, she became **President of the Theosophical Society in 1907**, based at **Adyar (Madras)**.
- In **1898** she founded **Central Hindu College, Banaras**, with the theosophist and jurist **Bhagwan Das**.
- Central Hindu College later merged into the **Banaras Hindu University**, founded in **1916 by Madan Mohan Malaviya (मालवीय)**. Besant is the college co-founder; Malaviya is BHU's founder — do not swap the two names.
- On social reform she pushed **girls' education**, criticised **child marriage**, and used the Theosophical ideal of universal brotherhood to soften rigid caste practice in the institutions she ran.
- Her papers were **New India** and **Commonweal**, used for both Theosophy and reform causes.
- She founded the **Home Rule League in 1916** and later became the **first woman President of the Indian National Congress, in 1917**. Her Home Rule and Congress-presidency career belongs to the freedom-movement political story, not this socio-religious topic.
- She is **not** the founder of the Theosophical Society; that credit stays with **Blavatsky and Olcott, 1875**.

> **Logic:** Besant = President from **1907**, Central Hindu College **1898**. Blavatsky/Olcott = founders, **1875**.

6.23 Sree Narayana Dharma Paripalana Yogam (SNDP) and Sri Narayana Guru

Sri Narayana Guru (1856–1928) | Kerala | Ezhava community uplift

- **Sri Narayana Guru** was a Kerala saint-reformer who worked mainly among the **Ezhava** community, then treated as a lower caste under Kerala's rigid caste practice.
- In **1888** at **Aruvippuram** he consecrated a **Shiva idol** himself, defying the rule that only Brahmins could perform consecration. This act is called the **Aruvippuram Pratishtha**.
- His teaching is summed up in the slogan **"One Caste, One Religion, One God for Man"** (*Oru Jathi, Oru Matham, Oru Daivam Manushyanu*).
- He built temples and monastic centres open to all castes, including the **Sivagiri Matha**.

- In **1903** his followers, led by **Dr Palpu** and the poet **Kumaran Asan**, founded the **Sree Narayana Dharma Paripalana (SNDP) Yogam** to organise the Ezhava community for education and self-respect.
- **Kumaran Asan** served as the Yogam's first general secretary and is also remembered as a major Malayalam poet.
- Narayana Guru inspired later Kerala reform, including support for the **Vaikom (वैक्कम) Satyagraha (वैकोम) (1924–25)**, a protest for lower-caste right of way on roads near the Vaikom temple, which also drew Periyar's support from Tamil country.
- SNDP is **not** a Bengal or Maharashtra body. It is the standard **Kerala / South stream** anti-caste institution.

> **Logic:** SNDP = Kerala, Ezhava, **1903**. Aruvippuram consecration = **1888**. Do not place it in Bengal or Maharashtra.

6.24 Singh Sabha Movement

Amritsar, 1873 | reaction to missionaries and Arya Samaj pressure | Sikh identity revival

- The first **Singh Sabha** was founded in **1873 at Amritsar** by **Baba Khem Singh Bedi** and **Thakur Singh Sandhawalia**.
- It grew out of anxiety over Christian missionary conversions and over the **Arya Samaj's shuddhi** campaign, which treated Sikhs as reconvertible Hindus.
- This Amritsar body is often called the **Sanatan (conservative)** wing, led by aristocratic and priestly Sikh leaders.
- A second, more reformist **Singh Sabha** was founded in **1879 at Lahore**, led by **Professor Gurmukh Singh** and **Bhai Ditt Singh**. This wing is called the **Tat Khalsa**.
- The Lahore/Tat Khalsa wing pushed a sharper Sikh identity, opposed caste distinctions inside Sikh practice, and promoted Gurmukhi publishing and education.
- The movement founded **Khalsa College, Amritsar, in 1892** for modern Sikh education.
- In **1902** the various Singh Sabhas united under the **Chief Khalsa Diwan**, based at Amritsar.
- This reform current later fed into the **Gurdwara Reform Movement** of the 1920s, which set up the **Shiromani Gurdwara Parbandhak Committee (SGPC) in 1920** to take gurdwara management out of hereditary mahant control.
- Singh Sabha is **not** a branch of the Arya Samaj. Both reacted to the same missionary and reform pressure but built separate, competing identities.
- Keep **Nirankari** (Dayal Das / formless-God reform, earlier nineteenth century) and **Namdhari / Kuka** (Baba Ram Singh; Topic 8 chronology) distinct from the Singh Sabha institutional stream.

> **Logic:** Amritsar Singh Sabha = **1873** (Sanatan wing). Lahore Singh Sabha = **1879** (Tat Khalsa). Chief Khalsa Diwan = **1902**. Nirankari ≠ Singh Sabha ≠ Kuka.

6.25 Pandita Ramabai

Pandita Ramabai Saraswati (1858–1922) | Maharashtra | Sanskrit scholar and women's reformer

- She was born to a Sanskrit scholar father, **Anant Shastri Dongre**, who unusually taught her Sanskrit and the shastras from childhood.
- Pandits of Calcutta recognised her scholarship and gave her the titles **Pandita** and **Saraswati** (सरस्वती) in 1878.
- In **1882** she founded the **Arya Mahila Samaj** at **Poona** to promote women's education and oppose child marriage.
- In the same year she testified before the **Hunter Commission** on the state of women's education in India.
- She travelled to England, where she **converted to Christianity in 1883**.
- In **1887** she published ***The High Caste Hindu Woman*** in the United States, exposing the suffering of upper-caste child widows.
- In **1889** she founded **Sharada Sadan**, a home and school for widows, first at Bombay and then moved to **Poona**.
- In **1898** she founded the **Mukti Mission** at **Kedgaon**, near Poona, sheltering destitute women, widows and famine victims.
- Do not confuse her with **D.K. Karve**: Ramabai ran women's shelters and wrote on widows' suffering; Karve headed the **Widow Remarriage Association** and later founded the **SNDT Women's University**.

> **Logic:** Ramabai = Arya Mahila Samaj **1882** + Sharada Sadan **1889** + Mukti Mission **1898**. She is **Maharashtra**, not Bengal.

6.26 Self-Respect Movement and E.V. Ramaswami Naicker (Periyar)

E.V. Ramaswami Naicker, "Periyar" (1879–1973) | Tamil country | anti-caste rationalism

- He first worked inside the **Indian National Congress** and took part in the **Non-Cooperation (असहयोग) Movement**.
- He played a leading role in the **Vaikom Satyagraha (1924–25)** in Travancore, a protest demanding that lower castes be allowed to use public roads near the **Vaikom Mahadeva temple**. He took over leadership of the satyagraha at one stage, alongside local Kerala leaders such as T.K. Madhavan.
- He **left the Indian National Congress in 1925**, unconvinced that Congress would fight caste inequality seriously.
- In **1925** he founded the **Self-Respect Movement**, attacking **Brahmanical priestcraft**, the caste system, and orthodox Hindu textual authority.
- He promoted **rationalism**, widow remarriage, women's rights, and inter-caste marriage, and demanded **temple entry** (मंदिर प्रवेश) and priesthood rights for all castes, not only Brahmins.
- His journal **Kudi Arasu** carried the movement's ideas in Tamil.

- He later founded the **Dravidar Kazhagam in 1944**, growing out of the Self-Respect Movement and linked to the earlier non-Brahmin **Justice Party** (जस्टिस पार्टी) current in Madras politics.
- The Self-Respect Movement is a **social and religious-reform** current first; its later party-political offshoots are a separate, later story.
- Both his Non-Cooperation participation and his 1925 exit from Congress are true and were tested together in a UPPCS statement question.

> **Logic:** Periyar = Self-Respect Movement, **1925**. Vaikom Satyagraha = **1924–25**, Travancore. He is a **South stream** reformer, not Bengal or Maharashtra.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS 2023 Q44): Periyar E.V. Ramaswami Naicker** participated actively in Non-Cooperation (1920–22) and the Vaikom Satyagraha (1924), and left the Indian National Congress in **1925** after communal seating at Cheranmadevi Gurukulam, launching the Self-Respect Movement.

6.27 Rahnumai Mazdayasnan Sabha (Parsi Reform)

Year: 1851 | Bombay | Parsi religious and social reform

- Founded in **1851 at Bombay** by **Naoroji Furdunji**, **Dadabhai Naoroji**, **S.S. Bengalee**, and **K.R. Cama**.
- Aimed at the modernization of Parsi religion, restoration of Zoroastrian religion to its original purity, and social reform including female education and removal of purdah.
- Its official mouthpiece was the fortnightly journal ***Rast Goftar*** (**The Truth-Teller**), started in **1851** by **Dadabhai Naoroji**.
- Do **not** confuse *Rast Goftar* (Parsi reform, Gujarati/English) with *Voice of India* (Dadabhai's political organ) or *Tahzib-ul-Akhlaq* (Sir Syed's Muslim reform journal).

> **Logic:** Rahnumai Mazdayasnan Sabha = **1851, Bombay** + **Naoroji Furdunji / Dadabhai Naoroji** + ***Rast Goftar***.

6.28 Bahishkrit Hitakarini Sabha and Dr. B.R. Ambedkar

Dr. B. R. Ambedkar (1891–1956) | Maharashtra / Pan-India | Dalit (दलित) uplift & anti-untouchability

- Dr. B.R. Ambedkar founded the **Bahishkrit Hitakarini Sabha** on **20 July 1924 in Bombay** for the moral, educational and material advancement of the depressed classes.
- Central motto of the Sabha: **"Educate, Agitate, Organise"** (शिक्षित बनो, आंदोलन करो, संगठित रहो).
- In **March 1927**, he led the historic (ऐतिहासिक) **Mahad Satyagraha** to assert the right of untouchables to draw drinking water from the public **Chawdar Tank** in Mahad (Maharashtra).

- On **25 December 1927**, he publicly burned the *Manusmriti* (मनुस्मृति) as a protest against caste discrimination.
- Founded key anti-caste journals: ***Mooknayak*** (**1920**, supported by Shahu (शाहू) Maharaj of Kolhapur), ***Bahishkrit Bharat*** (**1927**), ***Samata*** (**1928**), and ***Janata*** (**1930**).
- Formed the **Independent Labour Party in 1936** and the **All India Scheduled Castes Federation in 1942**.
- Do **not** confuse *Bahishkrit Hitakarini Sabha* (1924, Ambedkar) with *Depressed Classes Mission Society* (1906, V.R. Shinde) or *All India Anti-Untouchability League / Harijan (हरिजन) Sevak Sangh* (1932, Mahatma Gandhi (महात्मा गांधी)).

> **Logic:** Bahishkrit Hitakarini Sabha = **1924, Bombay** + **Dr. B.R. Ambedkar** + motto *"Educate, Agitate, Organise"*.

6.29 Master Fact-Locks — Socio-Religious Reform Movements High-Yield Repository

Reformer / Institution	Founder / Leader	Year / Place	Key Diagnostic Fact & Exam Anchor
Raja Ram Mohan Roy	Raja Ram Mohan Roy	1772–1833 (Bristol)	"Father of Indian Renaissance", "Prophet of Indian Nationalism", "Father of Modern India", "First Modern Man", "Yugdoot". Founded Atmiya Sabha (1815) and Brahmo Sabha (20 Aug 1828; renamed Brahmo Samaj). Opposed idolatry, polytheism, Sati (helped Bentinck pass Regulation XVII of 1829), and child marriage; advocated English scientific education. Title "Raja" given by Mughal Emperor Akbar II (1830) whom he represented in England; died at Bristol (Samadhi at Stapleton/Arnos Vale).
Tattvabodhini Sabha	Debendranath Tagore	1839 (Calcutta)	Founded to propagate Raja Ram Mohan Roy's monotheistic ideals and Upanishadic philosophy; journal *Tattvabodhini Patrika*; merged into Brahmo Samaj in 1859.
Brahmo Samaj Splits	Debendranath Tagore & Keshab Chandra Sen	1866 & 1878	In 1866, stripped of Acharya title, Keshab Chandra Sen founded **Brahmo Samaj of India (Bharatiya Brahmo Samaj)**; original body became **Adi Brahmo Samaj** under Debendranath. In 1878, after Keshab married his underage daughter to the minor Maharaja of Cooch Behar violating his own Native Marriage Act principles, Anand Mohan Bose and Shibnath Shastri broke away to form the **Sadharan Brahmo Samaj**.
Paramahansa Mandali	Durgaram Mehtaji, Dadoba Pandurang	1849 (Bombay)	Earliest socio-religious reform organization in Maharashtra; secret society breaking caste taboos (eating food prepared by lower castes); belief in one God.

Reformer / Institution	Founder / Leader	Year / Place	Key Diagnostic Fact & Exam Anchor
Prarthana Samaj	Dr. Atmaram Pandurang (inspired by Keshab Sen)	1867 (Bombay)	Joined by **Mahadev Govind Ranade** in 1869 ("Precursor of cultural renaissance in Western India") and R.G. Bhandarkar. Promoted monotheism, widow remarriage, raising marriage age, abolition of caste, and women's education.
Arya Samaj	Swami Dayanand Saraswati (Mulshankar Tiwari)	1875 (Bombay)	Born 1824 Morvi (Gujarat). Hoisted *Pakhand Khandini Pataka* (1867); HQ shifted to Lahore (1877). Masterpiece *Satyarth Prakash* (1875), *Rigvedadibhashya-bhumika*. Slogan: **"Go back to the Vedas"**; declared Vedas infallible; rejected Puranas, idol worship, avataras, animal sacrifices, child marriage. Called **"Martin Luther of India"**. Famous political assertions: *"Good government is no substitute for self-government"* and *"India for Indians"*; first to use the word **Swaraj** and advocate Hindi as national language; launched Shuddhi movement. Split into conservative/Gurukul faction (1902, Swami Shraddhanand, Lekhraj, Munshiram at Kangri Haridwar) and College faction (DAV College Lahore, Lala Hansraj & Lala Lajpat Rai).
Ramakrishna Paramhansa & Neo-Hinduism	Sri Ramakrishna (Gadadhar Chattopadhyay) & Swami Vivekananda (Narendranath Datta)	1897 (Belur Math, Howrah)	Ramakrishna taught essential oneness of all religions ("Joto mot, toto poth" — as many faiths, so many paths). Swami Vivekananda preached Neo-Hinduism and **"Practical Vedanta"**; historic speech at Chicago **Parliament of the World's Religions (1893)**; London lectures on Practical Vedanta (1896); author of *Jnana Yoga*, *Karma Yoga*, *Raja Yoga*, *Bhakti Yoga*. Founded Ramakrishna Mission (May 1897, Belur Math). Subhas Chandra Bose hailed him as "spiritual father of modern nationalist movement". Disciple Sister Nivedita declared: "The British Empire is rotten to the core, corrupt in every direction and tyrannical and mean."
Satyashodhak Samaj	Mahatma Jyotiba Phule	1873 (Pune, Maharashtra)	Born 1827; led powerful non-Brahmin and anti-caste movement for liberation of Shudras and Ati-Shudras. Authored *Gulamgiri* (1873, dedicated to American movement against slavery) and *Sarvajanik Satyadharma Pustak*. Wife Savitribai Phule pioneered female education (Bhiku-wada school 1848). Inspired Mukundrao Patil and Shankarrao Jadhav to found Bahujan Samaj (1910).
Dharma Sabha (Orthodox Reaction)	Raja Radhakant Deb	1830 (Calcutta)	Formed to defend orthodox Hindu social traditions and oppose Bentinck's abolition of Sati; nevertheless supported Western education for women.

Reformer / Institution	Founder / Leader	Year / Place	Key Diagnostic Fact & Exam Anchor
Radhaswami Satsang	Shiv Dayal Saheb (Seth Shiv Dayal Ji / Tulsi Ram / Swamiji Maharaj)	1861 (Agra)	Preached faith in *Satnaam* and *Anami*, devotion to Guru (living master), satsang, and moral living without ascetic withdrawal.
Dev Samaj	Pandit Shiv Narayan Agnihotri (Bhagwan Devatma)	1887 (Lahore)	Former Brahmo preacher; teachings compiled in *Dev Shastra*; emphasized moral and ethical conduct, guru devotion, and strict vegetarianism.
Lokahitwadi	Gopal Hari Deshmukh	1823–1892 (Pune)	Wrote 108 reform letters (*Shatapatre*) in weekly *Prabhakar* under pen-name "Lokahitwadi". Appointed to Governor-General's Council in 1880; attended Delhi Durbar wearing hand-spun Khadi.
Widow Remarriage in Maharashtra	Vishnu Parshuram Pandit	1850	Founded Widow Remarriage Association in Maharashtra; translated Vidyasagar's book into Marathi.
Age of Consent Act, 1891	Behramji M. Malabari	1891	Parsi social reformer from Baroda campaigned against child marriage through circulars; Act raised age of consent for girls from 10 to 12 years; fiercely opposed by Bal Gangadhar Tilak.
Indian National Social Conference	Mahadev Govind Ranade & Raghunath Rao	1887 (Madras)	Founded because INC avoided social reform deliberations to maintain political consensus; met annually alongside INC; launched famous "Pledge Movement" against child marriage.
Rajahmundry Social Reform Association	Kandukuri Veeresalingam Pantulu	1878 / 1881	Father of Telugu Renaissance; fought against nautch parties and arranged widow remarriages in Madras Presidency.
Servants of India Society	Gopal Krishna Gokhale	1905 (Poona)	Trained national missionaries for social service, tribal welfare, and education; Gokhale was Gandhi's political guru; Thakkar Bappa was a key member.
Theosophical Society	Madame H.P. Blavatsky & Col. H.S. Olcott	1875 (New York) / 1882 (Adyar, Madras)	Believed in ancient occult wisdom and Hindu karma/reincarnation. Annie Besant joined in 1889, arrived in India 1893; established Central Hindu College Banaras (1898); became President of Society in 1907.
Self-Respect Movement & Periyar	E.V. Ramaswami Naicker (Periyar)	1925 (Tamil Nadu)	Left Congress in 1925; launched Self-Respect Movement for backward classes; organized self-respect marriages without Brahmin priests; journal *Kudi Arasu*.
Bahishkrit Hitakarini Sabha	Dr. B.R. Ambedkar	20 July 1924 (Bombay)	Founded for socio-economic uplift and education of depressed classes; motto "Educate, Agitate, Organise"; started Marathi fortnightly *Bahishkrit Bharat* (1927).